

FERNANDO DIAZ

Lead Automation Engineer | QA Infrastructure & Tooling

San Diego, CA | fernandovalentan@gmail.com | [Portfolio](#) | [LinkedIn](#)

SUMMARY

QA Engineering leader with 10+ years architecting automation frameworks and test tooling. Experience managing QA functions as lead, mentoring engineers, and building tools adopted across teams. Recently built AI-augmented tooling including test execution dashboards and AI agent specifications.

LEADERSHIP & TOOLING HIGHLIGHTS

Test Automation Dashboard — AI-Augmented

Quality lead | Stakeholders: QA, Dev, Product, Executive

- Outcome: Non-technical stakeholders can trigger test scenarios without engineering support
- AI Workflow: Used Claude Haiku for initial code generation; validated and adapted for company-specific workflows

API Test Framework

Quality lead, framework adopted by Dev team | Coverage: 50+ endpoints, 4 user roles

- Outcome: Dev team writes own integration tests using the framework
- Leadership: Mentored 3 developers in automation best practices

Device Farm & Hardware Lab

Built and managed | Scale: 15+ iOS/Android devices, physical kiosk simulators

- Outcome: 70% reduction in hardware dependency; test runtime reduced from 6 hours to 45 minutes

Community Leadership

Developer — San Diego Organization Every Child Plays

- Volunteered to develop and published the team roster website for this organization

Guest Host — San Diego Robot Framework Meetup

- Presented on Appium + Robot Framework for mobile automation
- Connected with 50+ professionals in QA and Test Automation community

MANAGEMENT SKILLS

Team Building

- Mentored 5+ engineers; 3 promoted within 12 months
- Cross-department training: QA to Dev knowledge transfer
- Meetup hosting and community engagement

Tooling Strategy

- Build vs. buy decision-making
- AI-augmented development workflows
- Adoption planning for non-technical end users

API Platform Experience

- 50+ endpoint coverage with multi-role authentication testing
- Third-party integration validation
- Security bug identification across permission levels

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior SDET / Test Automation Architect

Automated Retail Technologies | San Diego, CA | Jan 2021 – Feb 2025

- Architected full-stack automation framework covering 50+ API endpoints, 4 user roles, and 15+ hardware kiosk placements
- Reduced regression testing from 3 days to 4 hours through 80%+ automation coverage
- Built desktop simulator of \$15K hardware kiosks, eliminating 70% of hardware dependency for dev team
- Mentored 3 developers in automation best practices, enabling dev team to write and maintain their own integration tests

Senior Mobile SDET

eSUB Construction | San Diego, CA | Jul 2016 – Jan 2021

- Built cross-platform automation framework covering API, Web, and Mobile platforms
- Established device farm with 15+ iOS/Android devices, reducing test runtime from 6 hours to 45 minutes
- Mentored 5 junior QA engineers; 3 promoted within 12 months

Senior Mobile QA Engineer

Fragmob LLC | San Diego, CA | Sep 2014 – Jul 2016

- Successfully tested and launched 15+ apps to iOS App Store and Google Play Store with zero critical post-launch bugs
- Implemented 10+ functional mobile test plans per project, standardizing QA process across agency

QA Engineer

High Moon Studios | San Diego, CA | Jan 2014 – Aug 2014

- Logged 300+ defects across mission/level, multiplayer modes, maps, and game systems prior to release

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Audio Engineering — G. Martell, CDMX, Mexico | 2002–2005